

BORG ≡ HUMAN?

Are we becoming more like machines, or are machines just enhancing our humanity?

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I'm usually the one complaining about all things technology, so it's a little baffling why I find myself being the only one of the team who thinks Cyborgs are very much our future, and should be something we strive towards.

Almost all of the team thinks that a future of AI and Cyborgs would essentially mean an end to the human species... and they say that as if it's a bad thing! I have no clue why we humans think we're the epitome of evolution, when if anything, evolution has shown us that nothing stays the same forever, and nothing lives forever.

First of all there is no direction to evolution and natural selection, so us getting wiped out by an asteroid and a million years from now, some octopus-looking species being the dominant one on the planet seems perfectly plausible to me. I can picture them sitting about at an under sea conference, discussing how their octopi ancestors discovered shelter and iron under layers of rock, which led to the first technological revolution, and then another learned octopus chimes in to suggest that the iron was left behind by a long dead alien race, which lived on the poisonous rocks above the water line. Cue cephalopod laughter in the form of squirts of ink and a rolling of eyes!

Anyway, coming back to reality, even if the big asteroid strike never comes (sadly), and we humans infest more and more of the earth, given enough time, we're going to see enough changes that will make the beings of that time essentially a different species to us. I'm one of the people who be-

lieves that technology is a catalyst, and will speed up evolution to an insanely fast generational churn. This is where the idea of transhumanism comes in.

TRANS-WHAT?

Oh calm down, we're not telling people which bathroom they need to pee in, we're talking about transhumanism, which is the idea that we will evolve beyond our current selves by using science and technology to enhance pretty much all of our senses. Yes, cyborgs in a nutshell, but not just anything as simple as strapping one's arm into a metal prosthetic.

will be even more comfortable with technology than we are, and their kids even more so, and so it continues. The technology bias in selection criteria is only going to increase, and thus, if you consider Agent 001's definition of cyborgs (using technology to enhance yourself), then we are already on the path towards selecting for cyborgism (is that a word? If not, it is now).

Imagine we eventually become a world where implants are considered normal. Sure it might be something only the rich can afford in the beginning, but eventually everyone gets access to technology. It's like smart-



Future humans?

In order for it to be evolution, we need to have some level of natural selection. And so there will be. Heck, aren't we already selecting for technology? Almost all jobs these days require some proficiency with technology, and if you cannot achieve that, you're likely to never rise in your job, and will get fewer raises, and might eventually be replaced by a machine. Our kids

phones. I remember owning a Palm Treo 600 in 2003, and everyone fawning over it, and it was the most useless thing ever. It was a smartphone only because all the others around it were so dumb. Sort of like the king of the idiots. Today with Android phones and iPhones in everyone's pocket, that old Treo looks more like a paperweight than a phone!